

Coastal Tourism

Shores of Gujarat: A Perfect Blend of Nature and Leisure

The sea has a unique ability to both relax and invigorate, making coastal destinations irresistible to tourists seeking quality time amidst tranquillity. If you're looking to escape the daily grind, experience adventure, or connect with divinity, Gujarat's beaches offer the perfect package.

Gujarat boasts the longest coastline in India, spanning 1,600 km, with pristine beaches that provide a rich tapestry of experiences. These coastal havens not only feature sun and sand but also offer a blend of divine temples, breath-taking marine life, captivating views of the Arabian Sea's sunset, and thrilling adventure sports.

The development of coastal tourism in areas such as Shivrajpur, Somnath, and Dwarka is carefully planned to strike a balance between promoting tourism, preserving the environment, and supporting the livelihoods of local communities.

Somnath Beach: Where Tranquillity Meets Scenic Beauty

Situated in the town of Somnath, Gujarat, Somnath Beach is a popular coastal destination celebrated for its scenic beauty, religious significance, and tranquil surroundings. With picturesque views of the Arabian Sea, serene waters, sandy shores, and soothing sunsets, the beach provides a peaceful retreat for visitors. More than 8 million tourists visited Somnath in the last one year.

The Government is actively transforming Somnath Beach into a world-class destination by introducing amenities such as picnic platforms, guided audio tours, hangout decks, history murals, sports zones, souvenir shops, and more. The cost of the development is about Rs 87.5 crore in the initial phases.

Shivrajpur Beach: A Pristine Blue Flag Destination

Shivrajpur Beach, near Dwarka, is a pristine white sand beach with crystal-clear azure waters. Awarded the prestigious Blue Flag beach certification in October 2020, the Government of Gujarat is committed to conserving its natural beauty and enhancing the overall tourist experience through thoughtful development. More than 6 lakh tourists visited this place in the last one year.

Mandvi: Royal Heritage and Sandy Shores

Mandvi, located 56 km south of Bhuj, is a fair-weather port with a 5-km-long sandy beach. The town boasts the famous Vijay Vilas Palace and a 400-year-old tradition of shipbuilding. Mandvi showcases Kutchi culture with its art of hand painting and embroidery, providing a rich royal heritage for tourists to explore. It offers many water sports adventures like water scooters, skiing, surfing, para-sailing and speed boating. The serene beauty of the beach adds to its charm.

Dwarka: Ancient Charm on the Arabian Sea

Dwarka, an ancient coastal town on the Arabian Sea, is a prominent tourist destination known for its historical significance, beautiful beaches, and rich marine diversity.

The town, known as the 'City of Gold' in ancient Hindu mythology, is an important destination for Hindu pilgrims due to the famous Dwarkadhish Temple. The town has several beautiful beaches and a rich diversity of marine flora and fauna. It is one of the few places in Gujarat where dolphins can be spotted.

About 75,000 tourists had visited Dwarka in 2022, while according to data, 62,915 tourists visited the place till August 2023. The place saw a surge of tourist footfalls of 6,18,460 during Diwali holidays. The Dwarka town is set to host a major oceanarium project, which will provide a boost to the tourism sector here.

Porbandar: A Coastal Blend of History and Scenery

Porbandar, an important port city, gives you a peek into history of India. Mainly, it has significance as the hometown of Sudama and Mahatma Gandhi. The city offers a rocky and sandy beach spanning nearly 10 km, making it a popular attraction. Besides the beach, the Porbandar city has a lot to offer to a visitor. Tourist spots, religious shrines, historical monuments or educational institutions, make it a place worth a visit.

Tithal: Black Sand and Beautiful Sunsets

Situated on the coastline of Valsad, Tithal, features a 5-km-long beach with black sand along the southern coast of Gujarat. Known for its flat and sandy terrain, the beach attracts thousands of tourists, especially during weekends and holidays, with its beautiful sunsets creating an inviting atmosphere in the evenings. Its proximity to the Shri Swaminarayan Temple also attracts tourists to visit the beach.

Other Important Beaches

Madhavpur Beach lies 58 kilometers from Porbandar. When travelling from Porbandar to Somnath by car, Madhavpur, known for its extensive coastal route, offers beautiful views. Madhavpur Beach is among the most tranquil and lovely locations to visit close to Junagadh. It is worth taking a family holiday because it is so serene. Coconut trees and other greenery line the shore and the sea is tranquil.

Okha Madhi Beach in Devbhoomi Dwarka boasts clean sand and beautiful sunrise and sunset views The shoreline is beautiful, with crystal-clear waters that are perfect for snorkelling. Lying between Bhatiya and Dwarka, the stunning Okha Madhi coastline can be reached from Dwarka. It's also an important turtle nesting site.